

STARTER

Field-by-Field Online Application Walkthrough

Canada - Visitor Visa (Temporary Resident Visa)

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

A Temporary Resident Visa (TRV, informally a “visitor visa”) is applied for online through your IRCC secure account (the paper form, for the small number of applicants who must apply on paper, is IMM 5257). It's decided by an IRCC visa officer against the Immigration and Refugee Protection Act (IRPA) and its Regulations (IRPR). Gather the following before you begin:

- Valid passport or travel document, with enough validity for your planned trip
- A digital photo meeting IRCC's specifications
- Details of your trip: purpose, planned dates, and where you'll stay
- Evidence of your ties to your home country: employment, family, property, or ongoing study
- Financial evidence covering your trip - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier)
- Details of any previous Canadian or other international travel, and any prior refusals

TRV OR eTA - CHECK WHICH YOU NEED

Not everyone visiting Canada needs a TRV. Nationals of certain visa-exempt countries flying to Canada instead need a much simpler Electronic Travel Authorization (eTA), not a TRV - and a TRV isn't required at all for some land/sea arrivals from the US in specific circumstances. Confirm which applies to your nationality and travel plans on the IRCC website before applying for the wrong one.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport. Declare any other nationalities, passports, or previous names.

2. Details of your visit

- Purpose of travel (tourism, visiting family/friends, business), planned entry and exit dates, and where you'll stay
- Business visitors can attend meetings, conferences, or negotiate deals without a work permit, provided the activity doesn't amount to entering the Canadian labour market - be specific and accurate about what you'll actually do

3. Family information

Details of your spouse/partner and children, whether they're travelling with you, and whether any are already in Canada or hold Canadian/permanent resident status.

4. Education and employment history

Your current job or studies, and how long you've held them - this, together with your financial evidence, is central to showing you have reason to return home.

5. Background and travel history

Previous visas, visits, refusals (from Canada or any other country), and any immigration violations - answer completely. IRCC checks this against its own and shared records.

6. Admissibility declarations

Standard declarations covering criminal convictions, medical conditions relevant to admissibility, and security concerns. Answer honestly.

7. Pay the fee and give biometrics

After submitting, you pay the processing fee (and a separate biometric fee, unless you're exempt or have given biometrics for another Canadian application within the reuse period). You'll then be instructed to visit a Visa Application Centre (VAC) to give fingerprints and a photo, unless you're exempt.

8. Upload supporting documents

Upload your financial evidence, ties-to-home documents, and any letter of invitation. IRCC may request additional documents (a "procedural fairness letter") if something in your file needs clarifying - respond by the stated deadline if this happens.